AND YET I RISE

COVER LETTER

“AND YET I RISE” is a journey of rebirth — the quiet transformation of a heart that was once bruised by loneliness, memory, and shadows, now learning to beat again with softness, hope, and love.

This book is not about forgetting the darkness — it’s about carrying the spark that survived it.

Through fragments of poetry, memory, romance, and raw self–reflection, the author writes about love — not just as a feeling — but as a gentle reconstruction of self.

From sleepless nights to slow sunrises, from self–doubt to self–worth, from breaking down to standing up again — this is the second heartbeat after silence.

This is not a story of sorrow —
It is a story of returning to life.

CHAPTER 1 : THE CONFESSION I COULD NEVER SAY

It started the day I entered college. I still remember walking into the seminar hall — a little lost, a little unsure, just another face in the crowd. And then… my eyes found her. She wasn't trying to stand out — yet she did. Her presence wasn't loud — yet it filled the room. There was a softness in her posture, a light in her eyes, and something about her — something I still can't fully explain — just quietly took hold of me.
That was the beginning.
That was the moment everything shifted.
And now… the words I never spoke:

I wish you knew
how many times I've wanted to tell you what you do to me.

How you walk past quietly —
but leave me filled with noise.
How your smile seems simple —
but somehow reassures something inside me.

तू जाने ना,
दिल में छिपी कितनी बातें हैं,
तू मुस्कुराके चुप–चाप
यूँ चली जाती है,
पर तेरी नज़र...
सब कह जाती है।

तू कितनी खूबसूरत हो,
और फिर भी खुद से पूछती है —
“मैं कैसी हूँ?”
अगर तू मेरी नज़र से खुद को देख पाती—
तो शायद समझ जाती,
कि तू फूलों का बाग़ नहीं—
पूरी बहार है।

When I see you,
something in me settles…
and something in me trembles.

Guzar gaye wo lamhe jinme hum khud ko kho dete the —
par tum aayi,
aur waqt rukna chahne laga.

तेरे बिन,
सब सुनसान है।
तेरी बातों के बिना,
तेरी आवाज़ के बिना,
दिल को चैन नहीं मिलता।

तेरी ख़ामोशी भी बोलती है —
और मैं...
तेरी आँखों की भाषा पढ़ लेता हूँ।

Yes — I know loving you might hurt one day,
maybe even deeply.
But I would still choose it.
Because even one moment with you
is worth a lifetime without you.

मैं मानता हूँ —
एक दिन दर्द भी होगा,
दिल भी टूटेगा,
पर फिर भी...
तेरे साथ जीया एक दिन
सौ ज़िन्दगियों से बेहतर होगा।

The truth is —
I don't want to *own* you,
I don't want to *possess* you,
I just want the chance
to stand beside you…
quietly
gently
truly.

This is the confession I could never say out loud —
but it has lived inside me all along.

CHAPTER 2 — MY SOUL TRIBE

I didn't just make friends.
I found *my people.*
The ones who didn't just walk into my life —
they *made home inside it.*

We didn't connect at first sight,
but somewhere between the second year and the third,
between random meetings and shared randomness,
between sarcasm and sincerity,
these people became my **soul tribe**.

From “Hello bro” to “O mere bsdk”

It started politely —
“Hello bro.”
“Bhai, kya chal raha?”

And slowly,
politeness evolved into shamelessness:

“Chup kar bsdk…”
“m** me le.”
“********** jhul ja”

This wasn’t disrespect —
this was love disguised as roasting.

We Roasted Each Other Like Breathing

We invented insults that would destroy outsiders but somehow strengthened us And at the same time, we would defend each other with:

- “bhai haina tera”
- “aree tnsn mat le I am there ”

This was friendship with claws, but claws made of soft emotions.

They Became My Backbone

These weren’t just companions —
they were my balance.

When days were heavy —
they lifted the weight.
When nights were loud —
they shared the volume.
When thoughts were messy —
they just sat beside me
and made chaos feel normal.

Sometimes we talked deeply about life…
sometimes about memes.

Sometimes about dreams…
sometimes about food.

But every conversation was ours.

Nicknames, Personalities, Identity

To the world I am Aakash.
But to them I'm:

- **Pookie Jaat**
- **Ashika**

They didn't just know my name — they knew my **essence**.

We Did Life Together

We shared:

- the same jokes
- the same music
- the same snacks
- the same stress
- the same deadlines
- the same headaches
- the same tea
- and many times…
  even the same brain cell 🤝

Late night hostel talks,
2AM laughter,
roasting sessions that never ended, silence that didn't feel awkward, and comfort that didn't need explanation.

We Turned Moments Into Memories

We pushed each other.
We annoyed each other.
We supported each other.
We lied to teachers for each other.
We embarrassed each other.
We defended each other.
We understood each other
without needing language.

We built a friendship that wasn't perfect —
but **real.**

My Realisation

These people
didn't just witness my college journey — they shaped it.

They are the reason college wasn't just an institution —
it was an era.
An emotion.
A soundtrack.
A story.

And one day when I look back,
I won't remember the marks,
I won't remember the lectures,
but I'll remember them —
my soul tribe —
the ones who turned
ordinary days
into unforgettable memories.

AUTHOR'S LETTER

I wrote this book at a different point in my life — a point where I finally began to breathe without pain, think without drowning, and feel without fear.
For a long time, I believed love was something meant for others — not for someone like me.

But slowly, gently, life showed me that love is not something you *receive* — it is something you *grow into.*

These pages carry pieces of my journey — the nights of slow healing, the rediscovery of joy, the softness of being seen, and the courage to finally love again — including loving myself.

If you find warmth, comfort, or familiarity in these words — know that your heart and mine have met in the quiet space between these lines.

Thank you for reading me.
Thank you for being here.
Thank you for rising — in your own way.

— **Aakash Sehrawat**